Tyler Stoeger

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Chicago — **Chicago, IL**
Ph.D. in Economics — Expected May 2027
M.A. in Applied Economics — May 2024
CMEP Exchange Scholar, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy — *2024*
Courses taken: Energy and Environmental Economics I and III

Purdue University Northwest — **Hammond, IN**
Bachelor of Science in Business, Major in Finance — May 2022
Minors in Economics and Applied Mathematics
GPA: 4.00/4.00; Highest Distinction

RESEARCH FIELDS

Environmental and Resource Economics; Applied Microeconomics; Public Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Behavioral Responses to Air Quality Information: Implications for Optimal Policy
2026 Graduate Silvia Saffrin Award for Excellence in the Third-Year Paper

Abstract. Air quality alerts can improve welfare by helping individuals avoid pollution exposure, but frequent warnings may reduce responsiveness and weaken the effectiveness of the alert system. This paper studies how people's outdoor activity responds to air quality alerts, how that response varies with recent alert history, and how these behavioral dynamics affect the optimal alert threshold. A model of optimal alert policy is combined with a fuzzy regression discontinuity design using air quality forecasts, alert issuances, and high-frequency foot traffic data from six U.S. metropolitan areas. Near the alert threshold, receiving an alert reduces daily visits to outdoor recreational points of interest by approximately 3.3 visits, or 9 percent relative to the sample mean. The response varies substantially with recent alert history: alerts reduce visits by roughly eight visits when one or two alerts have occurred during the previous seven days, but have little detectable effect after three or more recent alerts. A counterfactual simulation calibrated to New York City-specific pollution dynamics and behavioral responses places the welfare-maximizing alert threshold at approximately 80, below the current AQI threshold of 101. The results show that optimal warning policy depends not only on the pollution risks communicated by an alert, but also on how the frequency and sequencing of repeated warnings affect behavioral responsiveness.

WORKING PAPERS

Air Quality Forecasts in Practice — **Draft expected Nov. 2026**
This project examines the accuracy of official air quality forecasts and the persistence of forecasting errors. Using a panel of AirNow forecasts and realized air quality across U.S. metropolitan areas, the analysis characterizes forecast errors, examines differences between predicted and realized AQI distributions, and investigates geographic and temporal variation in forecast performance.

REFERENCES

Matthew Tarduno (Dissertation Chair) — **tarduno@uic.edu**
Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Illinois Chicago

Benjamin Feigenberg — **bfeigenb@uic.edu**
Professor of Economics, University of Illinois Chicago

Ben Ost — **bost@uic.edu**
Professor of Economics, University of Illinois Chicago

HONORS & AWARDS

Graduate Silvia Saffrin Award, University of Illinois Chicago — 2026
Chancellor's Medallion, Purdue University Northwest — 2022
Awarded to graduates earning the highest GPA in their academic college

RESEARCH GRANTS

Award for Graduate Research, UIC Graduate College 2025
$2,900 in research support
Undergraduate Research Grant, Purdue University Northwest Fall 2021
Undergraduate Research Grant, Purdue University Northwest Spring 2021

PRESENTATIONS

2026
Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Graduate Student Session, Houston, TX Forthcoming
2025
University of Chicago, Environmental and Energy Economics Graduate Student Workshop December
University of Illinois Chicago, Economics Active Research Lunch (EARL) November
2024
University of Illinois Chicago, Economics Active Research Lunch (EARL) November

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Chicago **Fall 2024; Summer 2025**
Research Assistant to Matthew Tarduno
Conducted literature reviews, collected and cleaned data, performed preliminary empirical analysis, and edited manuscripts for two research projects.
Purdue University Northwest **Jan. 2021 – May 2022**
Research Assistant to Amlan Mitra
Conducted literature reviews, collected and cleaned data, and supported preliminary empirical analysis across faculty and funded undergraduate research projects.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Chicago
Instructor of Record
ECON 300 - Econometrics Summer 2024; Spring 2025; Fall 2025
Designed and delivered lectures, assignments, examinations, and applied statistical-programming labs; supervised a teaching assistant.
Teaching Assistant
ECON 300 - Econometrics Summer 2023; Spring 2024; Fall 2026
ECON 534 - Econometrics I Fall 2023; Fall 2024
ECON 121 - Principles of Macroeconomics Fall 2022; Spring 2026
ECON 120 - Principles of Microeconomics Spring 2023; Fall 2023
ECON 220 - Microeconomics: Theory and Applications Spring 2023
ECON 510 - Microeconomic Theory II Spring 2024
Graduate Assistant
ECON 516 - Development Economics Spring 2026

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Berkeley/Sloan Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics, UC Berkeley 2025

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE); American Economic Association (AEA); Southern Economic Association (SEA)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software: R, Stata, MATLAB, LaTeX, Git/GitHub, Excel.
Additional: Spatial data analysis, geographic data processing, and counterfactual simulation.